PROJECT REPORT

Social Media Privacy and Digital Footprint Toolkit

Submitted by: Harshini
Department: CSE
Institution: Dhanalakshmi College of Engineering
Project type: AI Capstone — Website Demonstration
Academic year: 2026

1. Abstract

The Social Media Privacy and Digital Footprint Toolkit is an educational website prototype that helps users recognise common privacy risks in social media habits. It presents a fictional profile and an interactive checklist covering location sharing, public personal identifiers, password exposure, password reuse, and third-party application access. The website updates a checklist completion percentage and an illustrative risk score as items are reviewed. It does not connect to real social media accounts or perform a professional security audit.

2. Problem Definition

People may unintentionally reveal sensitive information through posts, profile biographies, screenshots, reused passwords, and connected applications. Users need a simple way to identify these risky habits and learn safer alternatives.

3. Objectives

- Raise awareness of social media privacy and digital footprints.
- Provide an interactive privacy checklist.
- Demonstrate progress feedback and an illustrative risk indicator.
- Recommend practical actions for safer online behaviour.
- Use fictional data and avoid collecting real personal information.

4. Proposed Solution

The browser-based website includes a privacy audit checklist, progress bar, risk score and level, remaining-items counter, Apply Safety Fixes and Reset Audit buttons, a Before vs After comparison, and privacy tips.

5. Tools and Technologies

- HTML5 — page structure and checklist controls.
- CSS3 — layout, colours, responsive styling, and progress bar.
- JavaScript — checkbox events, progress calculation, risk indicator, and reset/fix actions.
- Chrome or Edge — local browser demonstration.

6. Workflow

- Open index.html in a modern browser.
- Review the fictional profile and checklist.
- Tick items that represent risks in the sample profile.
- Observe the cleaned percentage, risk score, risk level, and remaining count update.
- Use Apply Safety Fixes to mark all items reviewed or Reset Audit to restart.
- Review the safer actions and privacy tips.

7. Risk Items and Safer Actions

Risk item	Recommended safer action
Location enabled in posts	Disable unnecessary location tagging and avoid posting live location.
Date of birth / college ID in bio	Remove or limit public visibility of identifying information.

Risk item	Recommended safer action
Wi-Fi password screenshot	Never post passwords or screenshots containing private credentials.
Same password reused	Use unique passwords for each account and enable two-factor authentication.
Third-party app access not reviewed	Review connected apps and revoke access that is no longer needed.

8. Testing and Expected Results

The website was tested by opening the local HTML file and checking that checkbox selections update the cleaned percentage and risk score. Reset returns the checklist to its initial state, and Apply Safety Fixes marks all items reviewed. Expected initial state: 0% cleaned and 100/100 illustrative risk. After all items are reviewed: 100% cleaned and 0/100 remaining illustrative risk.

9. Responsible AI, Ethics, and Limitations

- The profile and example risks are fictional; no real student records or passwords are used.
- The website does not connect to or scan actual social media accounts.
- The risk score is an educational illustration, not a validated probability or professional security assessment.
- Do not enter real passwords, private data, or confidential documents.
- Verify current recommendations against official platform guidance.

10. Conclusion

The toolkit demonstrates how a simple interactive website can support digital-footprint awareness through a checklist, visual progress feedback, risk-level illustration, and practical recommendations.

11. References

- NCSC, guidance on passwords and account security: https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/collection/top-tips-for-staying-secure-online
- CISA, Secure Our World: https://www.cisa.gov/secure-our-world
- Official privacy and security help pages of the relevant social media platforms; consult current versions before submission.